

# 21 Brutal Truths That Will Get You Ripped and Rich

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## Executive Summary

Brandon Carter hosts a wide-ranging stream: guest "Young Candlestick" (Greg) teaches a Claude AI-powered S&P 500 options day-trading cash-flow strategy, then Carter delivers 21 hard-won life and business principles he wishes he'd known in his 20s.

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## Intro, Sponsors & Housekeeping 0:51

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- Host: Brandon Carter ("King Keto," "Gymnasium Jesus," "The Southside Savior")
  - Co-host: DJ Chaita Grande; chat moderation by Minovia
  - **Sponsor 1: Go High Level (GHL)**
    - CRM Carter has used ~8–10 years
    - Free 30-day trial via his link
    - Use cases: schedule social posts in advance, manage leads, build funnels and lead magnets, AI Studio for interactive tools
  - **Sponsor 2: Splashman's Toronto Marketing Event**
    - Splashman — met Carter at 16, mentored by Carter, built a 7-figure business under age 25
    - Carter is the headliner; other top marketers on the lineup
    - Link posted in comments/description
  - **Running joke sponsor:** "Thought Repellent" — satirical product for men who get too much female attention; funded by super chats; target release mid-September
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## The Claude AI S&P Options Strategy (Young Candlestick) 0:512

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- Guest: Greg, a.k.a. "Young Candlestick"
  - 10 years trading experience
  - Passed Series 65 exam 2 years ago (not currently a registered investment advisor)
  - Chartered Market Technician (CMT) — licensed to analyze and forecast markets
  - TDM (now Schwab) certified options trader
  - Funded futures trader; trades live daily in Victory Trades
- **Legal disclaimer (emphasized repeatedly):** Everything is for educational purposes only. Options trading is extremely risky. Past performance does not guarantee future results. Consult a licensed financial advisor.

### Why Claude over ChatGPT?

- Greg used ChatGPT for years but results were inconsistent
- **Claude is better at managing/interpreting data** — switched to Claude and accuracy improved dramatically
- Currently using the free tier of Claude; Carter uses Claude Max + Codex Max
- Cost: paid Claude is ~\$20/month — Greg says it's worth upgrading

### The Asset: S&P 500 Index (SPX)

- Most widely traded options market / asset class
- **Tax advantage:** a portion of capital gains taxed as long-term capital gains (favorable rate vs. ETFs or individual stocks)
- Trades the SPX directly; smaller accounts can use **XSP** (one-tenth the size)

## The Core Goal

- Use Claude to **predict the closing price of the S&P 500** for the current trading day
- Not a magic system — it creates a "probability cone" using chart data, options data, volume, and indicators
- Human judgment + AI, not blind AI following

## Step-by-Step Process

- **Step 1 — Let the range establish**
  - Do NOT prompt Claude at market open (9:30 a.m. Eastern)
  - Wait **1–2 hours** after the open to let early volatility settle
  - Best deal on iron condors and butterflies is available in this window
- **Step 2 — Gather screenshots**
  - Capture: current price, expected move, options chain
  - Include multiple time frames; try to include volume and indicators
  - Tools: Thinkorswim (TD Ameritrade/Schwab) preferred; Robinhood data quality is inferior
- **Step 3 — Enter into Claude**
  - Upload the screenshots
  - Use a **consistent prompt** (see below)
  - Claude reads the chart, options data, and indicators → outputs a single most-likely closing price (the "anchor point")
- **Step 4 — Select the trade structure** (butterfly or iron condor)
- **Step 5 — Enter the trade; ride or die or exit early**

## The Exact Prompt

"Here is my S&P chart and option screenshots. It is currently [TIME]. The market closes at [TIME]. Here's the expected move: [X]. Give point estimate unbiased. Use all available information I've given you to come to the most likely closing price. If you had to pick one price, what would it be?" - Can also just upload screenshots and say: "Give me the most likely closing price." - **Key tactic — "threaten" Claude:** "Gun to your head, you have to pick a single closing price and be dead accurate. What is it?" - This forces low-variance, committed predictions - Tested via text-to-voice: "Gun to your head..." - Can re-prompt with fresh screenshots throughout the day; Claude will hone in further - Can ask Claude to remember accurate sessions and replicate those conditions

## Trade Structures

| Structure          | Risk/Reward                        | Win Rate         | Notes                                                                            |
|--------------------|------------------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Iron Condor</b> | Risk \$300 to make \$200 (typical) | ~67% with Claude | Wider range = better odds, less profit.<br>PDT rule removed — can exit any time. |

| Structure        | Risk/Reward                      | Win Rate                                  | Notes                                                     |
|------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Butterfly</b> | Risk \$100 to make \$1,000 (10x) | Lower                                     | Need market to close right at the predicted "sweet spot." |
| <b>Combo</b>     | Both simultaneously              | Higher probability + big payout potential | Best when Claude accuracy is high.                        |

- **Iron Condor logic:** Select a price range to capture. The wider the range, the better the probability but lower profit. Can exit early — Greg often hits most of max profit within 1–2 hours.
- **Butterfly logic:** Set the double short strike at Claude's predicted closing price. Landing in the "bullseye" = 5x–10x return. Slightly off = may still profit. Way off = lose full investment.
- **"Ride or die" approach:** Enter trade, hold till end of day. 4–5 minutes of total work per day.
- **Biggest risks:** Major news catalysts (wars, tariffs, Fed moves, Middle East escalation) that break the market out of its expected range. Works best on quiet, sideways market days.

### Summary Statistics (small sample, a few weeks)

- Average miss on SPX: **~10 points** (~0.14%) in either direction
- Two days: dead accurate (potential 20x–50x on butterfly)
- Slightly off days: iron condors pay (~67% win rate)
- Only one loss example in the two-week sample period (news catalyst caused breakdown)
- "The more data we collect, the more statistically significant it becomes"



### Live Trade Examples & Community Results [1:452](#)

- **August 18th example:** Claude predicted 7702; actual close 7691 (10 points off). Iron condor = ~70–100% return on investment.
- **Wrong day example:** Predicted 7680; market stayed near that for 3 hours, then news catalysts (bonds dropping, Middle East) broke it bearish. Greg still profited by exiting early before full breakdown.
- **Today's example (day of stream):** "Gun to my head" prompt → Claude said 7680. Iron condor struck around 7680. Final close landed within the iron condor range. Greg risked \$320 to make **\$180**. Scalable: do 10 contracts = \$1,800 profit same day.
- **Victory Trades community member results:**
  - N13: made \$400 trading live off Brandon's call-outs
  - Presie: made \$550 ("small day for him")
  - Greg: made ~\$350 (started red \$1,000, came back)
  - Dawson: up **50% in one month**
  - Chase: learned to trade 1.5 months ago; makes **\$300–\$900/day** using this strategy
  - Wolf Claw: iron condor = \$100 profit
- Victory Trades membership: access to Greg's daily trade alerts, options course (40+ hours), futures course, beginner course, live daily futures trading sessions. Link in description.

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## Nvidia & KMI Trade Ideas 2:233

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- **Nvidia (NVDA) — earnings tomorrow (day of stream)**
    - Broke out of \$212–213 level, pulled back to that same level → Greg leans bullish
    - Expected move priced in:  $\pm \$13$  ("Nvidia moves \$13 in 20 minutes normally")
    - If Nvidia tanks: possible 2–4 week broad market correction due to its heavy index weight
    - Preferred trade A (Carter): Buy 220 call / Sell 230 call, Oct 16 expiration → risk \$343, turns into \$1,000 if NVDA slightly higher in 2 months (2:1 payout)
    - Preferred trade B (Greg): Sell 200 put / Buy 195 put, Dec 18 expiration → risk \$300 to make \$200, benefits from seasonal bullishness in Nov–Dec
    - Preferred trade C (Carter): Buy 205 call / Sell 230 call → risk  $\sim \$1,100$ , max profit  $\sim \$2,500$  (already in the money)
    - Greg would NOT buy puts on Nvidia directly; would short **Intel (INTC)** on weakness if sector breaks — Intel has been relatively weak in the semiconductor space
  - **KMI (Kinder Morgan)**
    - Super chatter suggested bull flag
    - Greg: weekly/monthly charts could argue bull flag, but he sees a "middle finger / flick-off pattern" on shorter timeframes — generally bearish
    - Analyst price target:  $\sim \$36$ ; current price  $\sim \$31$
    - Key levels: support at \$30, high-volume node magnet at \$27.50, breakout above \$33–37
    - Greg's preferred trade if bullish: just buy the \$31 call ( $\sim \$130$ ), higher delta, less theta decay; no point selling the \$34 call for only \$0.20 in premium
    - Pays a dividend, but options traders don't receive the dividend
  - **SPY bull spread discussion:**
    - Carter floated: Buy 781 / Sell 840, Oct 30 expiration → risk \$577, max profit \$6,000 (10x)
    - Greg: unlikely SPY goes above \$800 by year-end; selling 840 call = only \$0.08 premium, pointless
    - Greg's preferred trade: Buy 780 call / Sell 800 call, December expiration → risk  $\sim \$1,400$ , max profit  $\sim \$3,000$ ; benefits from "Trump pump / Santa rally" in Nov–Dec
    - Alternatively: bullish put credit spreads on SPX, size in; one CMT money manager generates  $\sim 30\%$  per year doing only 4–5 trades annually selling 3-delta bullish credit spreads on S&P every 90 days
  - **Trading session notes (Q&A):**
    - Morning: study opening range breakouts, fair value gaps, stocks in play with news catalysts
    - Lunch: scout swing trades, manage portfolio
    - Power hour (3–4 p.m.): avoid active trading; algos fight for closing price, dealers pin options. Manage zero-DTE options.
    - Simulators recommended: Thinkorswim, NinjaTrader, TradeStation, Interactive Brokers, Webull. Robinhood has no simulator.
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## Q&A: Photography Business Niche Advice 5:373

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- Super chatter (22-year-old): wants to be a full-time photographer in Atlanta, ~\$100K potential, currently making ~\$1.5K/month; works part-time at Apple (\$22/hr); dad says get an MBA or stable job first
  - **Carter's advice framework: What → Who → How**
    - **Niche down ruthlessly** — "just photographer in Atlanta" = millions of competitors
    - Chatter's niche: portraits (studio, engagement, grad photos)
    - The **What** (portraits) is identified, but the **Who** needs sharpening
    - Graduates are seasonal — they only need photos once; not ideal for year-round 100K income
    - Better targets: people who need recurring portraits (e.g., newborn photographers — "people are making new people every day, especially in Atlanta")
    - **Why niching matters for testimonials:** If all clients are the same type, testimonials start looking identical → social proof is stronger and more convincing to future identical clients
    - Carter's own example: niche = **fitness business coaching** (not generic business coaching)
      - Doesn't compete with Tony Robbins, Grant Cardone, Ryan Serhant
      - Only ~5 real competitors
      - All testimonials look the same → ideal prospect self-selects immediately
    - Showed live testimonials: Jen (\$49,927 in April), Louis (\$4,800 in a week / \$10K for the month by the 14th), Corey (\$45K last month)
  - **On losing momentum with a full-time job:** 168 hours/week – 56 hours sleep – 40 hours work = **72 hours remaining**. Manage the calendar.
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## Go High Level Demo & Lead Magnet Strategy 4:066

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- GHL's **AI Studio** feature: build interactive tools (not just PDFs) as lead magnets
    - Carter built "Ripped Road Map" — users answer questions, get personalized body fat / weight loss data, submit email/phone to receive results
    - Also built a **keto meal plan generator** and a **macro calculator** — all created with one long prompt in GHL AI Studio
    - Leads flow directly into GHL CRM for email and SMS follow-up
    - Far more professional and effective than sending a PDF
  - 30-day free trial: use Carter's link in description
  - Carter's own "Fitness Revenue Roadmap" tool: 9-question quiz (~4 minutes), trained on a decade of Carter's fitness business coaching, outputs a personalized game plan and timeline
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## Truth 1: Manage Your Own Chemistry (PEDs) 4:516

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- Carter: 43 years old, tens of millions made online, in better shape than most

- **Claim:** "Every super successful guy I know in their mid-30s or older is on some sort of performance-enhancing drug. 100% of them."
  - Focus is primarily on **cognitive enhancement**, not just steroids
  - **Prerequisite:** Fundamentals must be locked in first — sleep, nutrition, training. Without the baseline, PEDs just make you "regular."
  - **Substances mentioned:**
    - **Nicotine** — scientifically proven to boost cognition and focus. Addictive but cheap. Carter wears a patch or uses Zyn/lozenges for virtually every recording session. Hermozi publicly endorses nicotine patches for intense work periods. "Nicotine itself is not bad for you — it's tobacco/smoking that's harmful."
    - **Modafinil** — anti-narcolepsy medication used off-label. Blocks receptors that cause tiredness (unlike Adderall which stimulates). Analogy: Adderall = slamming the gas; Modafinil = taking your foot off the brake. Requires already being rested to work. Carter used it daily while working two jobs AND making two YouTube videos/day early in his career. Get it from a doctor only.
    - **Adderall** — amphetamine, structurally similar to meth. Many high-level entrepreneurs use it. More intense than Modafinil.
    - **Caffeine** — mildest; Carter drinks pre-workout throughout recordings
  - *Disclaimer repeated multiple times: consult your physician before any of this.*
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## Truth 2: Discipline Is Overrated — Manufacture Motivation Instead [5:173](#)

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- Discipline = doing what you're supposed to do whether you want to or not. Carter's view: you can make yourself **want** to do it, making discipline unnecessary.
- David Goggins example: ran an ultramarathon uninvited with injured legs — that's not discipline, that's **wanting** to do it because he associates pleasure with being a badass.
- **Sigmund Freud's framework:** All human behavior is driven by moving toward perceived pleasure or away from perceived pain.
  - Problem: most people associate **pleasure** with parties, drugs, alcohol, instant gratification; and **pain** with hard work, early mornings, focus
  - Solution: **change your associations**
- **The List of Hate + The List of Great**
  - **List of Hate:** Write down every person who doubted you, rejected you, said you couldn't do it. Review it every morning and any time motivation lags. "If you don't work hard, the haters win."
    - Key insight: "If you don't do it, the haters weren't hating — it was a fair assessment of your capabilities."
  - **List of Great:** Imagine your fully realized future self. Write down every attribute: wake time, sleep time, diet adherence, workout consistency, hours worked per day. Every time you act in accordance with that list, you get a dopamine/adrenaline boost.
  - Over time, your pain/pleasure associations **flip** — you start associating pleasure with the hard work and pain with slacking

- You know it's working when people say "you work too much" or "relax" — because you now enjoy the grind as much as others enjoy vacations
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### **Truth 3: Track Leading Indicators, Not Lagging Ones [5:876](#)**

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- **Lagging indicator** = the goal itself (championship trophy, revenue milestone) — tells you what happened, not what to do
  - **Leading indicator** = the daily actions that mathematically guarantee the result
  - **Fat loss example:**
    - 1 lb fat = 3,500 calorie deficit
    - To lose 10 lbs in 5 weeks = **1,000 calorie/day deficit**
    - Track calories burned (Oura Ring, Apple Watch, Garmin) and calories consumed (MyFitnessPal or Claude)
    - Just focus on hitting the deficit today — math guarantees the outcome over time
  - **Sales/business example:**
    - Work backwards: What's your close rate? (e.g., 50%) → How many calls per day to hit revenue goal? → How many leads to generate X calls?
    - Daily leading indicator = number of leads reached out to
  - Frame each day as a **win** by checking off the leading indicators — removes the psychological weight of the distant goal
  - "You can be happy today as long as you hit the leading indicators today"
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### **Truth 4: Winners Push Limits; Most People Just Get Away With Things [6:224](#)**

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- Restaurant story: Carter weighs his food at a nice restaurant with a portable food scale. A friend says "you'd probably be in pretty good shape even if you didn't do that." Carter's internal reaction: "I'm not trying to *probably* be in pretty good shape. I'm trying to be the best I can be."
  - Key question to ask yourself multiple times a day: **"Am I trying to see how much I can get away with, or how much I can push myself?"**
  - Most people optimize for getting away with things; almost nobody is pushing their limits → the competition is thin
  - "The irony is that life becomes easier because the competition becomes scarce"
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### **Truth 6: Sleep Is Part of the Work [7:338](#)**

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- Carter tried to outrun sleep early in career → lost muscle gains and became depressed
- **Minimum: 7 hours per night** (older = slightly less needed; children need 12+, babies ~20 hours)
- Sleep quality tips Carter uses:
  - Blackout curtains + eye mask



- White noise (learned from baby sleep research; travels with earbuds)
  - **Chili Pad** (cold water circulated under mattress pad; set to constant temperature = like sleeping on the cool side of the pillow all night). Carter says it dramatically increases deep sleep and REM sleep as tracked by Oura Ring.
  - Track sleep quality: Oura Ring, Apple Watch, or Garmin
  - "You will make more money if you get better sleep" — quantity AND quality matter
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## **Truth 7: Design Your Environment for Success 7:525**

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- Biggest mistake: trying to become a better person in the same environment
  - **Principle of Strategic Friction:**
    - Things you want to do MORE: **decrease friction**
      - Carter's studio: lights always on, camera mounted to wall, monitors always ready → zero setup required to record
      - Pre-workout made the night before; workout clothes laid out; work area ready → wake up and go immediately
    - Things you want to do LESS: **increase friction**
      - No ice cream in the house → must order via Uber Eats or go to a store (friction = easier to say no)
  - "It's hard to make the right decision when you're surrounded by the wrong decisions"
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## **Truth 8: Control Your Emotional State 7:720**

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- Your decisions are made based on the emotion you feel at the moment — so controlling emotions is critical
- **Three levers to change your emotional state:**
  1. **Your body / movement**
    - Smile or laugh for 2 minutes even if you don't mean it → state changes
    - Sit or stand triumphantly, speak confidently → you start to feel those emotions
    - Carter's old office: if energy was low, everyone jumped on a trampoline for 30 seconds → emotional shift every time
    - "Motion creates emotion"
  2. **Your environment**
    - Physical environment: changing scenery (Carter walks by the Atlantic Ocean to reset mood)
    - Social environment: emotions are contagious — avoid chronic complainers; surround yourself with positive people
    - Carter's strategy: **"I am the head of state wherever I go"** — proactively uplift everyone around him (doormen, TSA, cashiers, valets) as a game, because:
      - It protects his own state from being "infected" by negative people
      - Positive feedback loop: their improved state feeds back into his

### 3. **Your thoughts** ← most powerful lever

- Whatever you think about, you will feel — whether it's real or not (pet death thought experiment)
  - Depression is often trained focus on negatives; thoughts are habit-forming
  - Carter was diagnosed with bipolar II depression — manages it partly through deliberate thought direction
  - **Language matters:** words are thoughts verbalized
    - Instead of "I'm sleepy" → "I need more energy"
    - Instead of "I don't have enough money" → "I need to figure out how to get more money"
  - "Focus on what you want to happen, not what's going wrong. Look through the windshield, not the rearview — that's why the windshield is bigger."
  - Not toxic positivity — acknowledge problems, focus on solutions
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## **Truth 9: Get a Mentor 8:574**

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- **Star Wars analogy:** Even a movie about green aliens and space magic considered it *too unrealistic* for Luke to master the Force without a mentor (Obi-Wan → Yoda)
  - **Michael Jordan:** Kept losing to the Detroit "Bad Boy" Pistons; wasn't strong enough. Got strength coach **Tim Grover** → went on to win 6 championships, multiple MVPs, gold medals
  - **Kobe Bryant:** Was losing in playoffs. Jordan told him to go see Tim Grover (Jordan = Obi-Wan, Grover = Yoda). Result: 5 NBA titles, multiple MVPs, scoring titles
  - "Two of the greatest athletes of all time couldn't succeed without a mentor. How the hell are we going to do it?"
  - Carter's own mentors: Elliot Hulse, Owning Hook, and others
  - **High Ticket Trainer (HTT) program results showcased:**
    - Leonardo (Mexico): \$39K month (record)
    - Corey Armstrong: moved from Detroit ghetto to Miami, bought his mom a car and a house; finished last year at **\$470,000**
    - One-on-one coaches for every member; live calls weekly; Carter reviews tracking sheets and watches sales calls
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## **Truth 10: Kill the Mediocre Mantras 9:071**

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- **Mediocre mantras:** "One won't hurt," "I worked hard all week, I deserve a day off," "Everything in moderation," "Just one won't kill you"
- These statements are technically true — but they're not the point
- **The real problem:** Every time you accept an exception, you **train yourself that inconsistency is okay**
- Carter: hasn't had a cheat meal in 3 years. No days off from training. On "off" days from lifting, still gets 10,000+ steps (trampoline park with son, walks, Chuck E. Cheese with nieces/nephews)

- Consistency during good times is a **rehearsal** for bad times: "If you can't stay consistent when things are good, what are you going to do when there's a tragedy?"
    - Personal example: Carter's cousin (like a brother) died in a car accident on a Friday. Didn't go to gym that day. **Was in the gym the next morning at 6 a.m.** before handling family matters. Back to business by Monday (did the Fresh and Fit podcast).
  - Inconsistency = boom-bust cycle → you never pick up momentum. Consistency = hockey stick curve
  - "Starting over is the hardest part. I'm scared of having to start over. So I just stay consistent every day."
  - Once you stop accepting inconsistency, being consistent becomes easy — it's a mental switch
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## **Truth 11: Control Your Calendar 9:607**

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- Bruce Lee: "If you love life, don't waste time — time is what life is made of"
  - **Math of the week:**
    - 168 hours total
    - – 56 hours sleep (8 hrs/night)
    - – 40 hours work
    - = **72 hours remaining** every week
    - Even after 7 hours of gym = 65 hours still available
  - **Prescription: Plan every single hour of every day in your calendar**
    - Do it for 1 week → shocked at productivity
    - Do it for 90 days → life changes completely
    - Do it for a year → "people will think you made a deal with the Illuminati"
  - Carter takes ~70 flights/year (50+ just to see his son in Georgia + business trips), runs a multi-7-figure business, has a girlfriend, spends time with nieces/nephews — all because the calendar is managed
  - "Put family time in the calendar. I probably spend more time with my family than you do."
  - To 20-somethings without kids: "Your mom wants you to go be somebody, not spend all your time with her"
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## **Truth 12: Stop Accepting Inconsistency 9:889**

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- **Confidence ≠ affirmations in the mirror.** Confidence = keeping the promises you make to yourself
  - Every time you break a self-promise, you erode self-trust
  - Dictionary definition: "Confidence — a firm trust in one's own powers and abilities"
  - Root of low confidence = inconsistency. Fix the inconsistency, confidence follows automatically
  - Analogy: if a friend kept promising to do things and never did, would you trust them? That friend is you.
  - Mediocre mantras ("one won't hurt") erode confidence over time; being hard on yourself and staying consistent builds it
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## Truth 13: Get Around Winners [10:228](#)

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- "When you're around winners, winning starts to feel normal"
- If everyone around you makes \$50K/year, \$100K feels rich. If everyone makes \$1M, \$100K feels like poverty
- **Miami effect:** ~12% of Miami population are paper millionaires (IRS data). Being around wealth changes your expectations
- Carter sits courtside at Heat games ~10 times/year → starts to feel normal
- Looks out his window and sees a Google co-founder's yacht with a helicopter landing pad → "Oh, there are other levels"
- Personal story: sent to military school in Chicago, roommate Corey Phillips (white kid) invited Carter home → mansion with horses. Dad was a podiatrist. "I was like, 'That's it?' And I thought, 'Okay, I guess I'll go to college.'" Being around it made it real.
- New York hustle: deliberately moved to Forest Hills (near mansions); biked through the rich neighborhood; later moved to Upper West Side (72nd & Broadway), worked out at Equinox with Michael Strahan
- HTT community: newcomers join live calls, hear members making \$5,000–\$50,000/month → belief makes them consistent

"A lot of times you're inconsistent because on the inside you don't believe it's possible. Once you can actually see it, it becomes real."

## Truth 14–15: You're Going Too Easy on Yourself / No Days Off [10:907](#)

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- Many people have been "giving themselves grace" for 10 years — that IS the problem
- Carter: "If I wake up after 6 a.m., I kind of hate myself. If I talked to a child the way I talk to myself when I slip, they'd take that kid away from you."
- The pain of self-criticism is a **tool** — it makes you more likely to stay on track (Freud's pain/pleasure principle again)
- **No days off** — literally: work on business every day, track macros every day, train every day
- "People don't rise to their ambitions. They fall to their standards. Raise the standards."
- Inconsistency is intolerable — treating it as such is what separates elite performers
- Working out is like brushing teeth: "Most of you brush your teeth no matter what's going on. Because it's a standard."
- Bills still come due even during tragedy — you can't afford to fall off

## Truth 16: Balance Kills Extraordinary Results [11:143](#)

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- "Only extreme results can come from extreme actions"
- When Carter made his **first million:** missed every party, every sports game, didn't watch TV shows (missed Iron Man, Avengers), worked obsessively

- Had extra motivation: father had died by suicide; needed to get family out of a tough situation
  - "Balance is not how you get extreme results — there are seasons when you need to be obsessed"
  - Currently still obsessed, despite having a kid, girlfriend, and a multi-7-figure business
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## 😊 Truth 17: Your Mood Is Your Responsibility [11:277](#)

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- Common narrative from successful people online: "I made all this money but wasn't fulfilled."
  - Carter: "I made my first million 12 years ago and it's been great. I have no idea what they're talking about."
  - Reason they're unfulfilled: they were **looking for money to make them happy** — that's not money's job
  - "Money's only job is to be exchanged for goods and services."
  - "You don't get happy to make money. You get happy and make money."
  - If you can't control your emotions when poor, you can't control them when rich — you're still a child reacting to circumstances
  - Toddler analogy: toddlers are 100% mood-controlled by circumstances. Adults who are still like that haven't grown up.
  - Carter's salesperson example: "If I can just get to \$20K/month, I'll be happy." → "No. Be happy NOW. Then go get the \$20K."
  - Emotions are your responsibility — not money, not your bench press, not your kids
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## 🧠 Truth 19: Success Takes More Effort Than You Think [11:519](#)

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- "If I had known what it would take to make my first million, I might not have gone for it."
  - People consistently underestimate: repetitions required, failures needed, calls, videos, workouts, reps
  - **Reframe the goal-setting question:**
    - Wrong: "How much effort do I need to accomplish this goal?"
    - Right: **"How much effort would I have to put in to make failure impossible?"**
  - Guitar teacher analogy: "Amateurs practice until they get it right. **Professionals practice until they can't get it wrong.**"
  - Approaching goals with this level of intensity eliminates fear, doubt, and uncertainty — "I can't lose if I do this"
  - Beauty: it takes away the fear AND makes you outrun the competition, because almost nobody is approaching things this way
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## 🔴 Truth 20: Stop Wanting It to Be Easy [11:732](#)

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- People ask: "What's the easiest diet? Easiest workout? Easiest business to start?" — wrong question. "Easy" is not the goal. **Results** are the goal.
- **Fat loss example:**
  - Many influencers recommend a 300–500 calorie deficit. Carter thinks that's insufficient.

- A 500-cal deficit is too easy to accidentally wipe out: eyeballing portions, AI food scanners being slightly off, FDA allowing food labels to be **off by 20%** legally → a 500-calorie item might be 600 calories
  - Carter's standard: **1,000 calorie daily deficit** — makes up for all sources of error
  - Carries a food scale everywhere (including nice restaurants)
  - Reframe difficulty as an opportunity: "This is where I can separate myself from the regular people — they won't do this. Let me do it harder."
  - Average American: 17 pounds overweight, less than \$1,000 in their bank account
  - Once you stop wishing it were easy and get excited when it's hard → things change
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## **Truth 21: You Need Accountability [11:977](#)**

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- "You probably already know how to improve your life. More knowledge is not the bottleneck."
- Accountability is **the great equalizer** — easiest lever to change your life
- **Practical accountability systems:**
  - Set weekly goals with a friend; use a shared project management tool (Trello, ClickUp, Notion); check in on each other's progress; make it a competition
  - Bet money on hitting a goal with a negative consequence if you miss ("people will do more to avoid loss than to gain" — loss aversion)
  - Example: "If you don't lose 10 pounds in 2 months, you owe someone \$10,000" → you will lose the weight
- **Hawthorne Effect** (industrial revolution studies):
  - When researchers visited factories to observe, productivity **skyrocketed** — every time, in every factory
  - When observers left, productivity returned to baseline
  - Same principle: kids behave when teacher is in the room; your employees do a full week of work in one day when the boss is watching
  - Carter's Airbnb experiment: put the whole team together for a week, posted tasks on a whiteboard → "people checked off a full day's work before noon"
- **High Ticket Trainer accountability structure:**
  - Every member gets a 1-on-1 coach
  - Daily tracking sheets (posts, leads, sales calls) visible to coach and Carter
  - Live group calls every week; Carter pulls up sheets live
  - "The week after I call someone out for not posting, they come back with clients"
- **Total Immersion Strategy (bonus for door-to-door salesperson super chat):**
  - Keep two pairs of headphones on you at all times (one charging, one in use; one waterproof for shower)
  - Any moment you're not talking to a human or sleeping: **listen to sales training**
  - Repeat same trainings over and over until the material is "in you, not on you"
  - "The game slows down. You know exactly what's going to happen — like dodging bullets in The Matrix."
  - Carter did this intensely when he needed fast cash to pay IRS back-taxes; dramatic results

- Recommended: Jeremy Miner, Grant (Cardone), sales books
- Commit for 90 days minimum
- Free tool: **Fitness Revenue Roadmap** (RIP Road Map) — link in description; 9-question quiz (~4 min), AI trained on Carter's decade of coaching, outputs personalized game plan and timeline to hit income goal as an online trainer. 100% free.